The global scenario has also turned unfavourable. Rising oil prices and falling exports have put pressure on the rupee. Increasing protectionism and the very real possibility of reciprocal trade wars do not bode well for India. As robotics and Artificial Intelligence become more ubiquitous, we will start to lose the advantages of low-cost manpower.

There are also the challenges of pollution and climate change and their impact on the health, livelihoods, and homes of millions of Indians. This is increasingly evident from rising health costs across the country and the human and financial costs of recent droughts and floods.

Gazing at the future, a range of questions confront us. The 10 most important ones in my view are:

1. How will we create opportunities for gainful occupation and/or employment for the 12 million young Indians who are entering the workforce each year?
2. Will our path to development be characterized by large-scale migrations from rural to urban areas and if so, do our cities have the governance structures and infrastructure to cope?
3. Can we find ways to make farming and agrarian activities not just sustainable, but attractive to young people?
4. Will industries create enough jobs or does the advent of automation, robotics and Artificial Intelligence curtail these possibilities?
5. Can we grow and develop our economy without fatally polluting our air, water and land, while protecting the precious bio-diversity of flora and fauna that India is blessed with in the face of a changing climate and its consequences?
6. How do we tackle the menace of corruption, cronyism and black money?
7. How will we cope with the growing polarization of views that threaten to divide the country on grounds of religion, caste and